ADVANCED RULES EXAM PREPARATION

Introduction

Welcome to the "Advanced Rules Exam Preparation" document, a comprehensive resource prepared by the International Table Tennis Federation (ITTF) Umpires and Referees Committee (URC) to aid aspiring candidates in their preparation for the Advanced Rules Exam. This guide is designed to offer valuable insights into the examination format by providing examples of questions and corresponding answers. While these examples serve as a foundation for your studies, it is crucial to acknowledge that the actual exam may include different sets of questions and answers.

As you go through this document, consider it a tool to sharpen your understanding of advanced table tennis rules, enhance your decision-making skills, and reinforce your knowledge. Remember that the purpose of these examples is to illustrate various scenarios and principles, preparing you for the diverse challenges the exam may present. It is highly recommended to supplement your preparation by thoroughly studying the official ITTF rules and regulations, Handbook for Match Officials (HMO) and FAQ to ensure a well-rounded grasp of the subject matter.

With this guideline, the ITTF URC aims to support your journey toward becoming a proficient table tennis official. Approach your studies with dedication, utilize these examples as a starting point, and embrace the opportunity to deepen your expertise in the complex world of table tennis rules and officiating. Best of luck in your preparation for the Advanced Rules Exam!

When the players change ends after the first game of a match, **X** says that the light from a window is shining into his eyes and asks for the match to be moved to the next table, which is not in use.

a. report to the referee immediately
b. move to the adjacent table, provided the umpire considers that the request is justified
c. reject the request, but report to the referee after the match
d. reject the request because there was no protest during the previous game

The correct answer is a.
3.3.1.2.10 The referee is responsible for deciding the acceptability of playing conditions

The blade of the racket

a. must be flat and rigid and not more than 4mm thick
b. can be covered on a side used for striking the ball with sandwich rubber, with pimples in or out
c. must be covered on both sides with sandwich or pimpled rubber, with one side black and the other bright red
d. can be covered on a side used for striking the ball with pimpled rubber, with pimples in or out

The correct answer is b.
a. is incorrect as there is no law regarding blade thickness 2.4.1
c. is incorrect as the blade doesn't have to be covered on both sides with rubber 2.4.3
d. is incorrect as pimpled rubber can only have pimples outward 2.4.3

For international competitions

a. players are suggested to leave their rackets on the table between games
b. players are normally permitted to take their rackets with them between games
c. players can take their rackets with them between games only with the permission of the umpire
d. players must leave their rackets on the table between games

The correct answer is c.
3.4.2.5 Unless otherwise authorised by the umpire, players shall leave their rackets on the table during intervals

A's racket makes a strange sound as he strikes the ball and on inspection it is found that there is a crack in the blade. The umpire should

a. allow **A** a few minutes to get another racket from the changing room
b. report to the referee
c. allow **A** to continue playing with the cracked racket since he says he has no other racket with him
d. require **A** to replace his racket immediately; report to the referee if **A** refuses

The correct answer is d
Since the blade is cracked it is no longer legal 3.4.2.4 applies and it must be replaced. It is not necessary to call the referee unless the player has no other racket immediately available

The striking surface of the racket may be

a. covered with sandwich rubber, with pimples inward or outward, with a total thickness of sandwich rubber and adhesive being no more than 4 mm
b. covered with pimpled rubber, with pimples inward or outward, with a total thickness of rubber and adhesive being no more than 2 mm
c. plain wood, dark in colour, either naturally or by being stained but not painted
d. two of the other three answers presented are correct

The correct answer is a.
b. is incorrect as pimpled rubber can only have pimples outward 2.4.3
c. is incorrect as the striking surface has to be covered with rubber 2.4.3

At the start of the fourth individual match of a team match, the player enters the court with his spare racket and informs the umpire that he wants to use his spare racket instead of the racket used in his previous match. The umpire should

a. allow the player to use his spare racket and collect it after that match for racket testing in the Call Area or Racket Control Centre
b. not allow the player to use the spare racket because it was not tested in the Call Area prior to the start of the team match
c. not allow the player to use the spare racket because he can only replace his first racket if it is accidentally damaged so badly during the last match and can no longer be used
d. call the referee

The correct answer is a.
Players are allowed to change their racket during a team match – 3.4.2.4 refers to an individual match

Player **X** brings his racket to the Call Area before the start of his match. Both sides of his racket are covered with sandwich rubber. On checking the coverings, you find that the red covering is not in the LARC. The umpire should

a. not allow the racket to be used because one of the coverings is not in the LARC
b. allow the racket to be used but only if the black side is used for striking the ball
c. disqualify the player
d. allow **X** to use the racket if his opponent has no objection

The correct answer is a.
3.2.1.3 Any ordinary pimpled rubber or sandwich rubber covering the racket shall be currently authorised by the ITTF

When they arrive for a doubles match, **X**/**Y** are wearing blue shirts, but **A**'s is red, and **B**'s is yellow. **A**/**B** say that they are from different Associations and that each is wearing his Association's designated colour. The umpire should

a. insist that **A** and **B** wear shirts of the same colour
b. report to the referee
c. allow them to wear different-coloured shirts anyway
d. allow them to wear different-coloured shirts as they are from different Associations

The correct answer is c.
3.2.2.7 The players of a team taking part in a team match, and players of the same Association forming a doubles pair in a World, Olympic or Paralympic Title Competition, shall be dressed uniformly, with the possible exception of socks, shoes and the number, size, colour and design of advertisements on clothing.
*There is **no** longer any requirement for doubles pairs from the same Association to be dressed uniformly, except at the designated events, so any reference to Association is now irrelevant.*

A protests that a watch **X** is wearing is so shiny that it is distracting him. **X** says that he wore the same watch in 3 earlier matches, and no one complained. The umpire should

a. ask **X** to remove or cover the watch whether he considers the protest is justified
b. ask **X** to remove or cover the watch if he considers the protest justified
c. reject the protest as the watch has been worn in previous matches without protest
d. report to the referee immediately

The correct answer is a.
HMO 8.4.7 If a player protests that he or she is being unsighted by brightly reflecting jewellery or other items worn by an opponent the umpire should ask for the offending items to be covered or removed. If this request is refused, the matter must be reported to the referee, whether or not the umpire supports the protest.

A's shirt is red. **X** initially wears a dark blue shirt, but he comes to the table for the 3rd game in a green shirt, saying that the blue one is too wet to wear and that he has no other spare shirt with him.

a. insist that **X** continue playing in the blue shirt
b. allow **X** to wear the green shirt, provided the Competition Manager agrees to the change of colour
c. allow **X** to wear the green shirt, because its colour is still sufficiently different from that of **A**'s
d. report to the referee

The correct answer is c.
HMO 8.1.6 If a player has to change a shirt for any reason during a match the new shirt does not have to be the same colour as the one being changed, but still has to comply with the above clauses.

Which of the following playing clothing is not allowed?

a. light blue shirt without sleeves
b. orange shirt with white sleeves if playing with white balls
c. one-part sports outfit
d. green shirt with an advertisement for the local cigarette company on the sleeve

The correct answer is d.
3.2.5.1.1 Advertisements or markings in or next to the playing area, on playing clothing or numbers and on umpires' clothing, shall not be for tobacco goods,

How many advertisements are allowed on the front, side or shoulder of a player's shirt?

a. 4 within a total area of 400 cm^2
b. 4 within a total area of 600 cm^2
c. 6 within a total area of 400 cm^2
d. 6 within a total area of 600 cm^2

The correct answer is d.
3.2.5.9.2 not more than 6 clearly separated advertisements, contained within a combined total area of 600cm^2, on the front, side or shoulder of a shirt,

Two players from different Associations are to play doubles together at an Open International Tournament and each has his own advisor during their match. Which of the following statements is true?

a. the two players should wear similar coloured shirts
b. the two players should each wear their own Association's uniform
c. if the advisor of one player is warned for illegal advice, this warning applies to the advisor of the other player as well
d. each advisor can advise his player only

The correct answer is c.
*3.5.1.2 where the players of a doubles pair are from different Associations each may designate an adviser, but with regard to 3.5.1 and 3.*5.2 these two advisers shall be treated as a unit

At the start of a match, the winner of the toss can

a. choose an end, after which the opponent must serve first
b. ask the opponent to serve first
c. ask the opponent to make the first choice
d. ask the opponent to serve first and the opponent can then choose an end

The correct answer is d.
2.13.2 When one player or pair has chosen to serve or to receive first or to start at a particular end, the other player or pair shall have the other choice.

The ends of the net shall

a. be attached to the supporting posts from top to bottom
b. be as close as possible to the supporting posts
c. be as close as possible to the supporting posts so that the gap between the net and the post is not more than 20mm
d. be well supported

The correct answer is a.
2.2.4 The bottom of the net, along its whole length, shall be as close as possible to the playing surface and the ends of the net shall be attached to the supporting posts from top to bottom.

As **A** runs around the side of the table to return a ball which bounces near the net, he trips and falls to the floor. His body on the floor prevents X from reaching the ball and **X** does not make a good return. The umpire should

a. award a point to **A** because **X** did not make a good return
b. award a point to **X** because **A** prevented him from making a good return
c. declare a let because **A** would be unable to continue owing to the accident
d. declare a let because **A** accidentally prevented **X** from making a good return

The correct answer is d.
The rally shall be a let:
2.9.1.3 if failure to make a service or a return or otherwise to comply with the Laws is due to a disturbance outside the control of the player;

X makes a good return and then stumbles and drops his racket. To steady himself, he rests the hand with which he had held the racket on the playing surface but does not move the table. **A**'s return misses the table. The umpire should

a. award a point to **A** because **X** touched the playing surface with his free hand
b. take no action because the playing surface was not moved
c. award a point to **A** because **X** touched the playing surface with his racket hand
d. award a point to **X** because **A** did not make a good return

The correct answer is a.
2.10.1.11 if an opponent's free hand touches the playing surface
2.5.6 The free hand is the hand not carrying the racket In this case both hands of player X were free hands

In doubles **X** served to **A** in the first game. At the start of the 2nd game, **B** serves to **X** and successive good returns are made by **X** and **A**. **Y**'s next return misses the table and it is then realized that the order of server and receiver is wrong. The umpire should

a. award a point to **A**/**B**, because **Y**'s return was not good, and continue with **A** serving to **X**
b. award a point to **X**/**Y**, because the wrong player served, and continue with **A** serving to **X**
c. award a point to **A**/**B**, because **Y**'s return was not good, and continue with **B** serving to **Y**
d. declare a let, because the wrong player served, and continue with **B** serving to **Y**

The correct answer is c.
2.14.3 In any circumstances, all points scored before the discovery of an error shall be reckoned.
2.14.1 … the order of serving chosen by the pair having the right to serve first in the game during which the error is discovered.

In the first game of a singles match, player **A** was given a warning for misbehaviour. In the second game, just as **A** was about to serve with the score at 8-1, **A** misbehaved again. Who is to serve next?

a. **A** to continue serving with the score at 8-1
b. **A** to continue serving with the score at 8-2
c. **X** to serve with the score at 2-8
d. **X** to serve with the score at 3-8

The correct answer is c.
X is awarded 1 penalty point making the score 8-2 at which score it is X's turn to serve – 2.13.3

A, a left-handed shake-hand player often holds the racket with both hands when making a backhand return. During a rally, as **A** makes a backhand return whilst holding the racket with both hands, his right hand touches the playing surface. The umpire should

a. call 'let' and tell **A** that he cannot play with both hands holding the racket
b. call 'stop' and award a point to **X**, and tell **A** that he cannot play with both hands holding the racket
c. call 'stop' and award a point to **X** because **A**'s free hand touched the table
d. take no action

The correct answer is d.
2.5.5 The racket hand is the hand carrying the racket. Holding the racket with both hands is allowable and, in this case, both hands are considered racket hands, so A does not have a free hand, therefore the return is good, and play continues

In doubles, with the score at 7-6, it is realized that **A**, who has been serving to **Y**, should have been serving to **X** at that stage. Neither the umpire nor the players can remember when the error occurred, although they know the server was changed at score 5-5. The umpire should

a. continue match at 5-5 with **A** serving to **X**
b. continue match at existing score with **A** serving to **X**
c. continue match at existing score with **A** still serving to **Y**
d. replay game in which error was discovered and use correct serving sequence

The correct answer is b.
2.14.3 In any circumstances, all points scored before the discovery of an error shall be reckoned.
2.14.1 … the order of serving chosen by the pair having the right to serve first in the game during which the error is discovered.

At the start of a doubles match, **A** serves to **X**. When the score is 6-4 in the 5th and final game, who should be serving to whom?

a. **A** serves to **X**
b. **Y** serves to **B**
c. **X** serves to **A** or **Y** serves to **B**
d. **A** serves to **Y** or **B** serves to **X**

The correct answer is c.
*Since A served first in the match, in the 5th game either **A** could have served to **X** or **B** could have served to **Y** first. Therefore at the score 6-4 either X or Y is serving, and, since it is the final game, the receiver changed when X/Y scored 5 points.*

In an individual event, **A**'s advisor signals for a time-out but **A** says he doesn't want one. The umpire should

a. allow a time out of up to one minute, and **A** is not entitled to another time-out
b. not allow the time-out because the player has the final decision
c. allow a time out, and because **A** is ready to play, the time out is over immediately
d. allow the time out and permit **X** to receive advice for not more than one minute

The correct answer is b.
3.4.4.2.2 If a player or pair and an adviser or captain disagree whether a time-out is to be taken, the final decision shall be made by the player or pair in an individual event and by the captain in a team event.

In an individual event a time-out

a. can be claimed once in a match by each player or pair, but not in the 1st game
b. can be called *between games* or between rallies in a game
c. can be claimed only by a player or pair and not by an advisor
d. can be called only between rallies in a game

The correct answer is d.
3.4.4.2.3 The request for a time-out, which can be made only between rallies in a game… ; all other answers are incorrect.

The referee may authorize a suspension

a. if a player is injured, but in no case may the suspension be longer than 10 minutes
b. if a player is injured, a suspension will normally not exceed 10 minutes but may be extended until all blood has been removed, even if it takes longer than 10 minutes
c. if a player is exhausted as a result of strenuous/exhausting play
d. if a player accidentally breaks his racket, he will be allowed not more than 10 minutes to repair it or find a replacement racket

The correct answer is b.
3.4.4.6 If anyone in the playing area is bleeding, play shall be suspended immediately and shall not resume until that person has received medical treatment and all traces of blood have been removed from the playing area.

After 4 closely fought games, the match score is 2-2 (2 games each). In the fifth game, **A** complains of dizziness brought on by his exertions/physical efforts in the match and asks for a suspension. The umpire should

a. stop the game and get medical attention for **A**, with the stoppage not to exceed 10 minutes
b. Inform A that if he does not resume play immediately, the referee would be called and he could forfeit the match
c. report this to the referee
d. grant an emergency suspension of play, not to exceed 10 minutes

The correct answer is b.
3.4.4.5 A suspension shall not be allowed for a disability which was present or was reasonably to be expected at the beginning of the match, or where it is due to the normal stress of play; disability such as cramp or exhaustion, caused by the player's current state of fitness or by the manner in which play has proceeded, does not justify such an emergency suspension

If a player is bleeding during a match, the umpire should

a. allow the injured player to rest for five minutes only
b. suspend the play until the injured player is treated by a medical official
c. let the match continue if the player says that he wants to finish the game as soon as possible
d. suspend play immediately until all traces of blood have been removed

The correct answer is d.
3.4.4.6 If anyone in the playing area is bleeding, play shall be suspended immediately and shall not resume until that person has received medical treatment and all traces of blood have been removed from the playing area.

In a team match consisting of 4 singles and one doubles matches, **B**, after playing the previous singles match, asks for 10 minutes break before he plays in the doubles match, which is next. The umpire should

a. allow him 5 minutes whether the opponents agree
b. require him to play without delay because play must be continuous
c. allow him 10 minutes if the opponents agree
d. call for the referee

The correct answer is a.
3.4.4.3 There shall be no intervals between successive individual matches of a team match except that a player who is required to play in successive matches may claim an interval of up to 5 minutes between those matches.

During an individual match play is continuous except for

a. an interval of 2 minutes between successive games
b. an interval of 1 minute between successive games
c. an interval of 5 minutes between the 3rd and 4th games in a match of the best of 5, and 1 minute between other successive games
d. an interval of 1 minute between successive games and other authorised intervals

The correct answer is d.
3.4.4.1.1 an interval of up to 1 minute between successive games of an individual match; 3.4.4.1.2 brief intervals for towelling after every 6 points from the start of each game and at the change of ends in the last possible game of an individual match.
b. is only partially correct

After every 6 points players are entitled to a brief interval for towelling. The assistant umpire, who is keeping time, should

a. take no action as the towel break is part of the playing time of a game
b. stop the watch as the towel break is not part of the playing time of a game
c. stop the watch, if she is of the opinion that the players are taking long towel breaks
d. comply with the referee's decision, which he or she will announce at the briefing before start of the tournament

The correct answer is b.
HMO Appendix A 14 Start the timer as the first player serves, stop, and re-start it for substantial breaks in play, such as time spent for towelling

In a singles match played under very hot and humid conditions, player **A** (who wears spectacles) several times requests short breaks to dry his glasses with his towel. The umpire should

a. allow the short breaks as player **A** is entitled to dry his glasses whenever necessary
b. request player **A** to dry his glasses with his shirt only, except during the 6-points towelling break, so as not to delay the game
c. not allow the short breaks as play must be continuous
d. examine the spectacles himself to decide whether player **A**'s glasses need to be dried or not

The correct answer is a.
HMO 13.3.2 Players are entitled to brief breaks for towelling after every 6 points from the start of a game, and at the change of ends in the last possible game of a match. Spectacle wearers can have particular problems, especially in hot conditions, and the umpire may allow them short breaks for cleaning between any rallies.

Which of the following statements is correct:

a. in doubles, each player of a pair is entitled to a warning for a doubtful service
b. if there is an assistant umpire, either the umpire or the assistant umpire can give a service warning
c. if there is an assistant umpire, only the umpire can give a service warning; the assistant umpire cannot give a service warning
d. if there is an assistant umpire, no service warning is issued

The correct answer is b.
2.6.6.1 If either the umpire or the assistant umpire is not sure about the legality of a service he or she may, on the first occasion in a match, interrupt play and warn the server;

When **A** serves, the ball first hits the net post and then his side of the table, from where it spins over the net. Before it can bounce on **X**'s side of the net, **X** catches it, above the table. The umpire should award a

a. point to **A** because **X** obstructed the ball
b. point to **X** because **A** did not make a good service
c. point to **A** because **X** prevented **A** from making a good service
d. let, because the ball was obstructed in a net-cord service, which was otherwise good

The correct answer is b.
2.6.3 Since the ball hit the net post before touching the table, the serve is not good

X serves and the ball bounces on his court, touches the top of the net and goes high in the air. **A** catches it, above the playing surface, with his free hand, which he then rests on the playing surface. The umpire should award a

a. point to **A** because **X** did not make a good service
b. point to **X** because **A**'s free hand touched the playing surface
c. point to **X** because **A** obstructed the ball
d. let, because the ball touched the net and was obstructed by **A**

The correct answer is d.
The rally shall be a let:
2.9.1.1 if in service the ball touches the net assembly, provided the service is otherwise correct or the ball is obstructed by the receiver or his or her partner;

A stamps (stamps means heavily stamping on the floor) his foot each time he serves; X is disturbed by this, and the noise is loud enough to be offensive and annoying to the spectators. The umpire should

a. award a point to X as stomping a foot during a service is not permitted
b. report this to the referee
c. handle under the Point Penalty System (PPS) and give A a warning
d. call a let and warn A not to stamp his foot; report this to the referee if A stamps his foot again

The correct answer is c.
3.5.2.1 Players and coaches or other advisers shall refrain from behaviour that may unfairly affect an opponent, offend spectators or bring the sport into disrepute

In serving, **A** tries to strike the ball as it rises but misses it. He tries again as it falls and, when it is just below the level of the playing surface, he strikes it upwards so that it bounces from his court, over the net and onto **X**'s court. **X**, taken by surprise, tries to return the ball but hits it into the net. The umpire should award a

a. let, because the ball was struck below the level of the playing surface
b. point to **A** because **X** did not make a good return
c. let, because **X** was not ready
d. point to **X** because the ball was struck below the level of the playing surface

The correct answer is d.
2.6.4 From the start of service until it is struck, the ball shall be above the level of the playing surface

In a doubles service, the ball touches the server's right half court and then the net. The umpire should

a. immediately call net, then let if the ball touches the receiver's half court
b. wait until the ball touches the receiver's half court before calling let
c. raise her arm but wait for the ball to touch the court before making a call
d. wait for the ball to touch the correct court or not before calling let or fault

The correct answer is d.
HMO Appendix C When the ball touches the net during service, the umpire should wait until the ball touches the correct court or half-court and make the appropriate call

The free hand, while in contact with the ball and at the instant of projecting the ball upwards, shall be

a. behind the server's left court end line
b. above the level of the playing surface and behind the server's end line
c. behind the server's right court end line
d. none of the other three answers presented are correct

The correct answer is d.
2.6.4 From the start of service until it is struck, the ball shall be above the level of the playing surface and behind the server's end line, and it shall not be hidden from the receiver by the server or his or her doubles partner or by anything they wear or carry. There is no reference to the position of the free hand in service, just the ball.

During a rally **A** strikes the ball while it is below the level of the table. It passes under the net assembly outside the table and then touches the playing surface on **X**'s side. The umpire should

a. award a point to **A**
b. award a point to **X**
c. call a let
d. take no action

The correct answer is d.
2.7.1 The ball, having been served or returned, shall be struck so that it touches the opponent's court, either directly or after touching the net assembly.
It is not necessary for the ball to go over the net.

At the score 6-6 in a doubles match, A should be serving to X. By mistake, B serves to X and successive good returns are made by X and A. The next return is made by Y, but the ball misses the table and goes out of play, when you (as umpire) realize that the wrong player served to start the rally

a. point to A/B, because Y's return was not good, and continue with A serving to X
b. point to X/Y, because the wrong player served, and continue with A serving to Y
c. point to A/B, because Y's return was not good, and continue with B serving to Y
d. let, because the wrong player served, and continue with A serving to X

The correct answer is a.
2.14.3 In any circumstances, all points scored before the discovery of an error shall be reckoned.
2.14.1 … the order of serving chosen by the pair having the right to serve first in the game during which the error is discovered.

At the start of the fifth game of a doubles match between **A**/**B** and **X**/**Y**, **X** served to **B**. Who should be serving and receiving after the players change ends with the score 2 – 5?

a. **B** to **X**
b. **A** to **X**
c. **A** to **Y**
d. **Y** to **B**

The correct answer is c.
Initial order X-B-Y-A so at 2-5 A is serving but the order is reversed A-Y-B-X.

With the score 4-2 in the last possible game of a doubles match, **A** serves to **X** and **X** misses the ball. Just after the ball touches the floor the time limit is reached. In the next rally

a. **A** serves to **Y**
b. **X** serves to **B**
c. **X** serves to **A**
d. **Y** serves to **A**

The correct answer is c.
Initial order A-X-B-Y so normally at 5-2 in the final game A would be serving to Y with the order reversed to A-Y-B-X-A. However expedite has been introduced between rallies so in terms of 2.15.3 …; if the ball is not in play when the expedite system comes into operation, play shall resume with service by the player who received in the immediately preceding rally. Since X received in the previous rally then X serves to A.

At the start of the final game of a doubles match, **A** serves to **X**. When the score is 2 - 6 in the final game, who could be serving to whom?

a. **A** to **X**
b. **B** to **X**
c. **X** to **A**
d. **Y** to **B**

The correct answer is b.
At 2-6 either A or B is serving, A->Y or B->X.

During the first game in a doubles match, **A** serves to **X** and the timekeeper calls “time” during the rally. To start the next rally under the expedite rule

a. **A** serves to **X**
b. **X** serves to **A**
c. **X** serves to **B**
d. **B** serves to **Y**

The correct answer is a.
2.15.3 If the ball is in play when the time limit is reached and the expedite system is due to come into operation, play shall be interrupted by the umpire and shall resume with service by the player who served in the rally that was interrupted

The umpire can call "let" and warn a player the first time he makes an illegal service

a. only if no assistant umpire has been appointed
b. only if the assistant umpire says he could not see the service action
c. only if he is sure that the server gained no advantage
d. in no circumstances

The correct answer is d.
2.6.6.1 If either the umpire or the assistant umpire is not sure about the legality of a service he or she may, on the first occasion in a match, interrupt play and warn the server
The service is illegal, not doubtful.

A return may be good if

a. the ball is struck by the racket handle then the blade in a continuous stroke
b. the ball goes under the projection of the net bracket beyond the table
c. the ball accidently strikes first the finger, then the racket
d. all other answers presented are correct

The correct answer is d.
2.10.1.7 if an opponent deliberately strikes the ball more than once in succession
2.7.1 The ball, having been served or returned, shall be struck so that it touches the opponent's court…
All returns are good

A makes a good but very high return which **X** moves in to kill (smash); just then C wins his match on the adjoining table and lets out a victory yell which startles (surprised) **X** so much that he misses the ball. The umpire should award a

a. point to **A** as **X** failed to make a good return
b. let, as the umpire decides that **X** missed the ball because of a disturbance beyond his control
c. point to **X** because he would have won it anyway
d. point to **X** only if **A** agrees he would have won it anyway; otherwise a let is called

The correct answer is b.
The rally shall be a let:
2.9.1.3 if failure to make a service or a return or otherwise to comply with the Laws is due to a disturbance outside the control of the player;

Player **A** strikes the ball beyond the sideline after it has completely crossed the playing surface on his side without touching the table but before it crosses the end line. The umpire should

a. award a point to **A**
b. award a point to **X**
c. call a let
d. take no action

The correct answer is a.
2.10.1.4 if the ball passes over his or her court or beyond his or her end line without touching his or her court, after being struck by an opponent; The ball is out of play as soon as it crosses the sideline

During the first game of a match you warn **X** for shouting abuse at **A**, although this does not appear to bother **A**. In the second game **X** again shouts and physically threatens **A** when he loses a point. The umpire should

a. report to the referee immediately
b. warn **X** again for bad behaviour
c. hold up a yellow and a red card and award 1 point to **A**
d. take no action, provided you are sure that **A** is not being disturbed

The correct answer is a.
3.5.2.2 If at any time a player, a coach or another adviser commits a serious offence the umpire shall suspend play and report immediately to the referee; for less serious offences the umpire may, on the first occasion, hold up a yellow card and warn the offender that any further offence is liable to incur penalties.
Physically threatening an opponent is regarded as a serious offence and the referee should be called immediately.

Just as **X** is about to make a return shot, **A** shouts out loudly which causes **X** to miss the ball. The umpire should

a. call a let
b. call a let and give a yellow card to **A** for misbehaviour during the rally
c. call fault and give one penalty point to **X**
d. take no action

The correct answer is b.
2.9.1.3 if failure to make a service or a return or otherwise to comply with the Laws is due to a disturbance outside the control of the player;
3.5.2.2 If at any time a player, a coach or another adviser commits a serious offence the umpire shall suspend play and report immediately to the referee; for less serious offences the umpire may, on the first occasion, hold up a yellow card and warn the offender that any further offence is liable to incur penalties.
Deliberately shouting is misbehaviour, but not considered serious, to PPS would apply.

A serves at the **score 8-10**. As the ball, returned by **X**, lands on the playing surface the match clock shows that 10 minutes have expired. The umpire should

a. call "let" and continue under the expedite system with **A** serving
b. call "let" and continue under the expedite system with **X** serving
c. allow play to continue but start the next game under the expedite system
d. allow play to continue and take no further action

The correct answer is d.
2.15.2 The expedite system shall not be introduced in a game if at least 18 points have been scored.

When the expedite system is in operation

a. the receiver wins the point if he makes twelve good returns counting the return of service as the first return
b. each player serves one point in turn; the stroke counter counts when the return is good
c. in singles the receiver of the last point in a game always serves the first point in the next game provided that the match is not over
d. none of the other three answers presented are correct

The correct answer is d.
2.15.4 Thereafter, each player shall serve for 1 point in turn until the end of the game, and if the receiving player or pair makes 13 correct returns in a rally the receiver shall score a point.
2.15.5 Introduction of the expedite system shall not alter the order of serving and receiving in the match, as defined in 2.13.6.
a. is not correct as the receiver has to make 13 returns; b. is not correct as the stroke counter counts as soon as the ball is struck, the umpire decides whether the return is good; c. is not correct in terms of 2.15.5

In timing a match,

a. time should be started when the ball is first served and stopped at the end of each rally
b. the umpire or assistant umpire time the pre-match practice, each game, the intervals between games and any time-outs; time is stopped whenever the ball leaves the playing area
c. the assistant umpire times the pre-match practice, each game and the intervals between games, the umpire must time any time-outs. Time is stopped for any delay such as a long conversation between playing partners in doubles
d. the umpire or assistant umpire time the pre-match practice, each game, the intervals between games and any time-outs. Time is stopped whenever the ball leaves the playing area and any delay such as a long conversation between playing partners in doubles

The correct answer is b.
3.3.2.5 Either the umpire or the assistant umpire may:
3.3.2.5.5 time the duration of the practice period, of play and of intervals.
HMO Appendix A 14 Start the timer as the first player serves, stop, and re-start it for substantial breaks in play, such as time spent for towelling or retrieving the ball from outside the playing area.

Which of the following statements is correct

a. if any game lasts 10 minutes the remaining games of the match will be played under expedite
b. expedite begins when any game reaches 10 minutes unless each player or pair has 9 or more points; expedite continues until the end of the match
c. if time is called when the ball is not in play, the player that received in the previous rally serves the first point in expedite
d. all other answers presented are correct

The correct answer is c.
2.15.3 If the ball is in play when the time limit is reached and the expedite system is due to come into operation, play shall be interrupted by the umpire and shall resume with service by the player who served in the rally that was interrupted; if the ball is not in play when the expedite system comes into operation, play shall resume with service by the player who received in the immediately preceding rally.

The stroke counter in an expedite rule match counts

a. the server's strokes out loud, calling "13" after he hits his 13th stroke including the serve
b. the receiver's good returns out loud, calling "point" when his 13th return hits the table
c. the server's strokes silently, calling "point" after he hits his 13th stroke, counting the serve as stroke number 1
d. the receiver's strokes out loud, calling "13" after he hits his 13th stroke

The correct answer is d.
HMO 15.2.2 … the stroke counter is required to count aloud the return strokes of the receiving player or pair, including the return of service, from "one" to "thirteen". The call should be made immediately after the receiver has struck the ball and not delayed until the return has been judged good or the ball has gone out of play. If the 13th return is good, the umpire should call "stop" and award a point to the receiver.

In the first game of a singles match, with the score at 0-0, **A** serves to **X**. The umpire then calls a let because the ball touched the net. Before **A** can serve again, both player **A** and player **X** approach the umpire and request that the rest of the match be played under the expedite system. The player to serve next is

a. **A**, as the expedite system cannot be introduced until at least 1 point has been scored
b. **A**, as no point has been scored
c. **X**, as **A** was the last server
d. ask the referee for a decision

The correct answer is c.
2.5.3 A let is a rally of which the result is not scored.
2.15.3 …. if the ball is not in play when the expedite system comes into operation, play shall resume with service by the player who received in the immediately preceding rally.

In a match between **A** and **X**, **A** has just served, and the rally is continuing. The umpire interrupts the rally to introduce the expedite system. Which of the following statements is correct?

a. the umpire should not have interrupted the rally and should only introduce the expedite when the rally has ended
b. in the next rally **A** serves to **X**
c. in the next rally **X** serves to **A**
d. the umpire tosses a coin to determine if **A** serves to **X** or **X** to **A**

The correct answer is b.
2.15.3 If the ball is in play when the time limit is reached and the expedite system is due to come into operation, play shall be interrupted by the umpire and shall resume with service by the player who served in the rally that wasinterrupted;

Under misbehaviour regulations

a. the umpire shows a yellow card when giving a warning
b. the umpire shows a red card when directing an advisor to leave
c. the umpire shows a yellow and a red card when awarding a penalty point
d. all other answers presented are correct

The correct answer is d.
3.5.2.2 … the umpire may, on the first occasion, hold up a yellow card …
3.5.2.7 …if a coach or another adviser who has been warned commits a further offence in the same individual match or team match, the umpire shall hold up a red card and send him or her away from the playing area …
3.5.2.3 … if a player who has been warned commits a second offence in the same individual match or team match, the umpire shall award 1 point to the offender's opponent and for a further offence he or she shall award 2 points, each time holding up a yellow and a red card together.

During the first game **A** throws his racket into a surround and the umpire gives **A** a warning, displaying a yellow card. At the end of the game, **A** kicks a surround. The umpire should

a. again, warn him because the game is over
b. award a penalty point to **X** and start the next game with **X** leading 1-0
c. call the referee
d. ignore the incident because **A** was upset with himself

The correct answer is b.
3.5.2.3 … if a player who has been warned commits a second offence in the same individual match or team match, the umpire shall award 1 point to the offender's opponent…
HMO 17.3.3 Penalty points may sometimes be awarded after a game has ended, or 2 penalty points might be awarded against a player when his or her opponent needs only 1 point to win the game. If the match has not ended any "unused" points are transferred to the next game of that individual match, so that it starts at the score of 0-1 or 0-2 in favour of the offender's opponent

In the first 2 singles of a team match, **A** is warned, and **B** incurs a penalty point. When later in the team match, they are playing as a doubles pair, **A** intentionally breaks the ball by stepping on it. The umpire should

a. formally warn **A**/**B**
b. award 2 penalty points to **X**/**Y**
c. award 1 penalty point to **X**/**Y**
d. report to the referee

The correct answer is b.
3.5.2.6 … at the start of a doubles match the pair shall be regarded as having incurred the higher of any warnings or penalties incurred by either player in the same team match.
HMO 17.3.4 In a team match, warnings and penalties are carried over to subsequent individual matches. A doubles pair is regarded as having incurred the higher of any warnings or penalties incurred by either of the players; thus, if one has been warned in a previous match and the other had incurred 1 penalty point, a first offence by either of them in the doubles match would incur 2 penalty points.

In the first 2 singles of a team match, **A** is warned, and **B** incurs a penalty point. When later in the team match, they are playing as a doubles pair, **A** intentionally breaks the ball by stepping on it. What penalties carry forward to each player's next singles match?

a. none
b. 1 penalty point each for **A** and **B**
c. 2 penalty points each for **A** and **B**
d. 1 penalty point for **A**, 2 penalty points for **B**

The correct answer is b.
3.5.2.6 A warning or penalty incurred by either player of a doubles pair shall apply to the pair, but not to the non-offending player in a subsequent individual match of the same team match;
HMO 17.3.4 …A warning or penalty during a doubles match applies to the pair during that match, but only the offending player will carry it over to a subsequent individual match.

In the second singles of a team match, **B** incurs a penalty point. When later in the match **A** (who has not been penalised before) and **B** are playing as a doubles pair, **B** angrily kicks down a surround after losing a point. The umpire should

a. formally warn **A**/**B**
b. award 2 penalty points to **X**/**Y**
c. award 1 penalty point to **X**/**Y**
d. report to the referee

The correct answer is b.
3.5.2.6 … at the start of a doubles match the pair shall be regarded as having incurred the higher of any warnings or penalties incurred by either player in the same team match.
HMO 17.3.4 In a team match, warnings and penalties are carried over to subsequent individual matches. A doubles pair is regarded as having incurred the higher of any warnings or penalties incurred by either of the players; thus, if one has been warned in a previous match and the other had incurred 1 penalty point, a first offence by either of them in the doubles match would incur 2 penalty points.

In the second singles of a team match, **B** incurs a penalty point. When later in the match **A** (who has not been penalised before) and **B** are playing as a doubles pair, **B** angrily kicks down a surround after losing a point. What penalties carry forward to each player's next singles match?

a. none
b. 2 penalty points each for **A** and **B**
c. no penalty for **A**, 2 penalty points for **B**
d. 1 penalty point for **A**, 2 penalty points for **B**

The correct answer is c.
3.5.2.6 A warning or penalty incurred by either player of a doubles pair shall apply to the pair, but not to the non-offending player in a subsequent individual match of the same team match;
HMO 17.3.4 …A warning or penalty during a doubles match applies to the pair during that match, but only the offending player will carry it over to a subsequent individual match.

In the first 2 singles of a team match, players **A** and **B** each are given a warning for misbehaviour. When later in the match they are playing as a doubles pair, **A** intentionally breaks the ball by stepping on it. What penalties carry forward to each player's next singles match?

a. none
b. 1 penalty point each for **A** and **B**
c. 2 penalty points each for **A** and **B**
d. 1 penalty point for **A**, warning for **B**

The correct answer is d.
3.5.2.6 A warning or penalty incurred by either player of a doubles pair shall apply to the pair, but not to the non-offending player in a subsequent individual match of the same team match;
HMO 17.3.4 …A warning or penalty during a doubles match applies to the pair during that match, but only the offending player will carry it over to a subsequent individual match.

In the first 2 singles of a team match, **A** is warned, and **B** incurs a penalty point. When later in the match they are playing as a doubles pair, **A** intentionally breaks the ball by stepping on it and **X**/**Y** are awarded 2 penalty points. What penalties carry forward to each player's next singles match?

a. none
b. 1 penalty point each for **A** and **B**
c. 2 penalty points each for **A** and **B**
d. 2 penalty points for **A**, 1 penalty point for **B**

The correct answer is b.
3.5.2.6 A warning or penalty incurred by either player of a doubles pair shall apply to the pair, but not to the non-offending player in a subsequent individual match of the same team match;
HMO 17.3.4 …A warning or penalty during a doubles match applies to the pair during that match, but only the offending player will carry it over to a subsequent individual match.

After the umpire gives a warning or awards a penalty point the assistant umpire

a. places cards by the scoreboard as directed by the umpire
b. places a yellow card by the scoreboard after a warning but takes no special action after the award of penalty points
c. places a red marker by the scoreboard next to the yellow marker after the award of a penalty point
d. places a red only marker by the scoreboard after the award of a penalty point

The correct answer is c.
HMO 17.2.3 When a formal warning has been given, a yellow marker should be placed near the score indicator, next to the score of the player who has been warned. Similarly, if a player has had a penalty point awarded against him or her, both a yellow and red marker should be placed near the score indicator

In the 1st game of a five-game match, **X** served first in the match. **A** is given a warning and for later bad behaviour in the game his opponent, **X**, is awarded a penalty point. In the 2nd game, **A**, before serving at the score 10-10, intentionally breaks the ball. The umpire should

a. call for the referee
b. award **X** 1 penalty point and continue the game with **X** serving 11-10
c. award **X** 2 penalty points and start 3rd game with **X** serving 0-0
d. award **X** 2 penalty points and start 3rd game with **X** serving 1-0

The correct answer is c.
3.5.2.3 … if a player who has been warned commits a second offence in the same individual match or team match, the umpire shall award 1 point to the offender's opponent and for a further offence he or she shall award 2 points
In this case awarding X 2 penalty points makes the score 12-10 to X, which is the end of that game. Since X served first in game 1, he/she serves first in game 3

In a team match A/B/C vs X/Y/Z, B gives illegal advice to A in the first match and is warned. In the next individual match of the team match, A gives illegal advice to B. The umpire should

a. give **A** a warning, showing a yellow card
b. show a red card and require **A** to leave the area; he cannot return until the completion of the team match
c. show a red card and require **A** to leave the area; he can return at the completion of **B**'s match
d. show a red card and require **A** to leave the area; he can return only to play his next match

The correct answer is d.
3.5.1.4 After a warning has been given, if in the same team match or the same match of an individual event anyone again gives advice illegally, the umpire shall hold up a red card and send him or her away from the playing area, whether or not he or she was the person warned.
3.5.1.5 In a team match the dismissed adviser shall not be allowed to return, except when required to play

During a team match, between rallies, **X**'s captain keeps calling out to him in a language that the umpire does not understand, and from **X**'s actions the umpire is sure that he is being given advice. The umpire should

a. take no action
b. take no action, provided he is satisfied that the calls do not disturb **A**
c. warn the captain and send him away from the playing area if the calls continue
d. warn the captain and report to the referee if the calls continue

The correct answer is a.
3.5.1.3 Players may receive advice at any time except during rallies…

Doubles pair **A**/**B** are from different Associations and speak different languages. Each player has a separate advisor. In the first game, **A**'s advisor is warned for illegal advice during the game. During the next game **B**'s advisor signals **B** what serve to use. The umpire should

a. give **B**'s advisor a warning showing a yellow card
b. show **B**'s advisor a red card and require the advisor to leave the area
c. show a red card to both advisors and require both to leave the area
d. take no action

The correct answer is d.
3.5.1.3 Players may receive advice at any time except during rallies provided play is not thereby delayed
Since this advice is not given during a rally it is legal.

During a team match advice may be given by

a. anyone on the team bench but only between games
b. anyone on the team bench but only between games and during authorized suspensions
c. one designated advisor whenever the ball is not in play
d. anyone on the team bench whenever the ball is not in play

The correct answer is d.
3.5.1.1 In a team event, players may receive advice from anyone authorised to be at the playing area.
3.5.1.3 Players may receive advice at any time except during rallies
2.5.1 A rally is the period during which the ball is in play

When one player of a doubles pair is in a wheelchair due to a disability and the partner is standing

a. when serving to the player in a wheelchair the ball must not bounce on the receiver's side and return in the direction of the net
b. either player can make a return
c. there is no difference from regular rules
d. when serving to the player in a wheelchair the ball must not cross the sideline on the receiver's side

The correct answer is a.
2.9.1.5 if the receiver is in wheelchair owing to a physical disability and in service the ball, provided that the service is otherwise correct,
2.9.1.5.1 after touching the receiver's court returns in the direction of the net;
d. is not correct as it is a doubles match and the ball crossing the sideline in service only applies to singles matches

In a wheelchair doubles match, **A** begins the rally by serving to **X**. During the rally, as **A** makes a good return, the footrest of his chair crosses the imaginary extension of the centre line of the table. **X** is unable to make a good return, but his partner returns the ball. The umpire should

a. award the point to **A**/**B** because the wrong player returned the ball
b. take no action because the ball is still in play
c. award a point to **X**/**Y**
d. declare a let

The correct answer is c.
2.10.1 Unless the rally is a let, a player shall score a point
2.10.1.15 if, where an opposing doubles pair includes at least one player in a wheelchair, any part of the wheelchair or a foot of a standing player crosses an imaginary extension of the centre line of the table
HMO Appendix F

In a women's wheelchair doubles match between **A**/**B** and **X**/**Y**, **A** serves correctly to **X**, however the ball goes over the sideline of **X**'s right-hand court. As **X** makes a good return, she raises her hand appealing for a let which the umpire does not call. **B** fails to make a good return but in doing so appeals for a let saying she was distracted when **X** raised her hand. The umpire should

a. allow a let as **B** was distracted by **X** raising her hand and advise both players to allow play to continue even if they think the service is a Let
b. allow a let as the ball went over the sideline of **X**'s right-hand court
c. award a point to **X**/**Y** but advise **X** to allow play to continue even if she thinks the service is a let
d. award a point to **A**/**B** because **X** caused a distraction

The correct answer is a.
2.9.1 The rally shall be a let:
2.9.1.3 if failure to make a service or a return or otherwise to comply with the Laws is due to a disturbance outside the control of the player

As it is a doubles match, the ball crossing the sideline in service only applies to singles matches, so the service was good; however X raising her hand incorrectly caused a distraction

One player of a doubles pair, player **B**, is in a wheelchair, and her partner, player **A**, is standing. During a rally, just as **A** is making a return, **B**'s foot touches the floor. The umpire should

a. call let and caution **B** that her foot must not touch the floor
b. award a point to **X**/**Y** as **B**'s foot touched the floor during the rally
c. award a point to **X**/**Y** because **B** caused a distraction
d. take no action

The correct answer is d.
2.10.1.14 if both players or pairs are in a wheelchair due to a physical disability and 2.10.1.14.3 his or her opponent's footrest or foot touches the floor during play. Because both players are not in a wheelchair, 2.10.1.14.3 does not apply.
HMO Appendix F

In a doubles match **X**, a standing athlete, serves to **A**, who is in a wheelchair because of a disability. The service, which is otherwise good, bounces in **A**'s right half court and then goes off the side of the table. **A** returns the ball and **Y** misses the subsequent return. The umpire should

a. award a point to **A**/**B**
b. award a point to **X**/**Y**
c. call a let
d. take no action

The correct answer is a.
As it is a doubles match, the ball crossing the sideline in service only applies to singles matches, so the service was good

X fails to make a good return and the umpire awards a point to **A**. **X** protests that **A** accidentally struck the ball twice and **A** agrees, although the umpire does not think he did so. The umpire should award a

a. point to **X**, because both players agree that the original decision was wrong, and the umpire is not certain
b. let, because the umpire is not certain whether **A** struck the ball twice
c. point to **A** because a decision once made cannot be changed
d. point to **A**, because even if **A** did strike the ball twice it was not deliberate

The correct answer is d.
2.10.1 Unless the rally is a let, a player shall score a point
2.10.1.7 if an opponent deliberately strikes the ball more than once in succession

The assistant umpire raises his hand and calls "side" to indicate that the ball returned by **X** hit the side of the table nearest to the assistant umpire, but the umpire is sure it touched the top edge. The umpire should

a. call let because the assistant umpire's call could have affected the players
b. call let because he and the assistant umpire disagree
c. award a point to **A** because the assistant umpire has the final decision
d. award a point to **X** because the umpire has the final decision

The correct answer is c.
3.3.2.4 The assistant umpire shall:
3.3.2.4.1 decide whether or not the ball in play touches the edge of the playing surface at the side of the table nearest him or her
HMO 12.2.3 the assistant umpire is solely responsible for edge ball decisions at the side of the table nearest to him or her

After the assistant umpire calls 3 faults against one player the player protests that the assistant umpire is not interpreting the service law correctly. The player wants to appeal to the referee. The umpire should

a. stop the game and call for the referee whether or not the umpire agrees
b. ask the player to continue or face penalties under the point penalty system
c. show the player a yellow card and ask the player to continue immediately
d. call the referee if the umpire agrees the assistant is making mistakes interpreting the service law

The correct answer is a.
HMO 4.6.1 A player, or in a team match his or her captain, may appeal against what he or she believes to be a wrong rule interpretation by the umpire, assistant umpire or stroke counter

In an individual match a player can appeal

a. to the referee against an umpire's interpretation of the service rule
b. to the umpire against an assistant umpire's decision that his return missed the side of the table nearer to the assistant umpire
c. to the umpire against a stroke counter's error in counting strokes
d. to the umpire against an assistant umpire's decision that he struck the ball in service while it was above the table

The correct answer is a.
HMO 4.6.1 A player, or in a team match his or her captain, may appeal against what he or she believes to be a wrong rule interpretation by the umpire, assistant umpire or stroke counter

In a team event an appeal can be made

a. only by the individual participating in the match during which the appeal has arisen
b. only by the advisor of the team making the appeal
c. only by the captain of a team participating in the match in which the question has arisen
d. by the individual if his captain so agrees

The correct answer is c.
3.3.3.6 in a team event an appeal may be made only by the captain of a team participating in the match in which the question has arisen.
HMO 4.6.1 A player, or in a team match his or her captain, may appeal against what he or she believes to be a wrong rule interpretation by the umpire, assistant umpire or stroke counter

At the end of a rally the umpire should

a. call the score immediately the ball is out of play
b. signal the result immediately the ball is out of play but delay calling the score until the players are ready to start the next rally
c. delay the signal and the calling of the score until the players are ready to start the next rally
d. signal the result immediately the ball is out of play but may delay calling the score until she is satisfied that the players will be able to hear it

The correct answer is d.
HMO 18.1.2 The score should normally be called as soon as the rally has been decided and the umpire should not wait until he or she judges that the players are ready to resume play. However, if there is loud applause or a player is retrieving the ball from the back of the playing area he or she may prefer to delay his or her call slightly until he or she is satisfied that both players or pairs will be able to hear it.
Appendix A 15 After the end of each rally indicate the result by the appropriate hand signal, and as soon as practicable thereafter by calling the new score

After the first game the assistant umpire

a. changes the score indicator immediately, changing the game score then changes the points scores to 0-0
b. changes the score indicator immediately, changes the points scores to blank then changes the game score
c. changes the score indicator just before the players return for the next game, changing the points scores to blank then changes the game score
d. changes the score indicator just before the players return for the next game, changing the game score then changes the points scores to blank

The correct answer is c.
HMO Appendix A 22 Just before the players return for the next game, set the points score indicators to the blank position and alter the appropriate games score indicators to reflect the result of the previous game

In a match played under the expedite system, the players speak different languages and cannot agree on a language suitable to both. The stroke-counter should call the number of strokes in

a. English or in any other language acceptable to the players and the umpire
b. the language of the Association organizing the event or in English
c. one of the ITTF official languages
d. any language decided by the referee

The correct answer is a.
3.4.1.3 The score and, under the expedite system, the number of strokes shall be called in English or in any other language acceptable to both players or pairs and to the umpire.

Player **A** did not bring his racket to the Call Area before the match but gives it to the umpire in the playing area before the start of the match. What are the tasks of the umpire with regards to this racket?

a. the umpire does a visual inspection of the racket (e.g. damage to coverings and blade, any other irregularity)
b. the umpire tests the racket in the field of play (thickness, flatness, LARC and any other irregularity)
c. the umpire does a visual inspection of the racket (e.g. damage to coverings and blade, any other irregularity) and collects the racket after the match for an after-match test
d. no inspection by the umpire at the table, but the umpire collects the racket after the match for an after-match test

The correct answer is c.
Workflow description
https://www.ittf.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/12/WORKFLOW-DESCRIPTION-Call-Area-and-RCC-01122018-ITTF-website.pdf
If a racket has not been tested before the match, the match umpire shall proceed to do a visual inspection
▪ Damage to coverings and blades, trimming, coverings correctly affixed to blade, extensions of coverings, layers of blade are continuous also into the handle, any other irregularity
Rackets not presented before the match will always be tested after the match

In a Class 4 singles match, during a long rally, one of the small wheels falls off from **A**'s wheelchair, which had 2 small and 2 large wheels. The umpire should

a. call let and have the wheelchair repaired before continuing the match
b. call let and ask **A** to replace the broken wheelchair with another wheelchair right away
c. award a point to **X** as **A**'s wheelchair is missing a wheel
d. allow the rally to continue

The correct answer is d.
HMO Appendix F Wheelchairs must have at least two large wheels and one small wheel at the start of and throughout a rally
Since the wheelchair still has one small wheel it is legal and no action is required

In a Class 5 doubles match, **A** makes a good serve to **X**. In making the return with a forehand smash, **X** lifts his right thigh off his wheelchair. A's wheelchair crosses the imaginary extension of the centreline of the table as he returns the ball. The umpire should

a. award a point to **A**/**B** as **X** fails to maintain minimum contact with the seat of his wheelchair
b. do nothing and let the rally continue
c. award a point to **X**/**Y** as **B** should be the one to return the ball from **X**
d. award a point to **X**/**Y** as **A**'s wheelchair crossed the imaginary extension of the centreline

The correct answer is d.
2.10.1 Unless the rally is a let, a player shall score a point
2.10.1.15 if, where an opposing doubles pair includes at least one player in a wheelchair, any part of the wheelchair or a foot of a standing player crosses an imaginary extension of the centre line of the table
HMO Appendix F

In a wheelchair singles match between **A** and **X**, **A** lifts his body from his wheelchair such that neither of his thighs make contact with the wheelchair seat after making a good return to a wide ball. **X** fails to make a good return. The umpire should award a

a. point to **X** because **A** failed to maintain contact with his chair
b. point to **A** because **X** failed to make a good return as **A** lifted his thighs off the seat only after striking the ball
c. let and warn **A** to maintain contact with the seat of his chair
d. point to **A** but warn him to maintain contact with the seat of his chair

The correct answer is b.
2.10.1.14 if both players or pairs are in a wheelchair due to a physical disability and
2.10.1.14.1 his or her opponent does not maintain a minimum contact with the seat or cushion(s), with the back of the thigh, when the ball is struck;
HMO Appendix F/HMO 12.1.6
A player who is in a wheelchair due to a physical disability and who does not maintain a contact with the seat or cushion with the rear side of at least one of the thighs just before striking the ball is considered to be gaining an unfair advantage and the opponent is awarded a point. In this case the thighs were lifted after striking the ball.

In a singles match of a Para tournament, player **A** requests an injury break as he is unable to play temporarily due to the nature of his disability. The umpire should

a. not allow the injury break as the disability was already present at the start of the match
b. allow the shortest possible injury break because it is necessary to be more considerate towards a player who is disabled
c. call the referee
d. not allow the injury break because disabled players are not entitled to request injury breaks

The correct answer is c.
HMO 13.5.4/Appendix F If a player with a disability is unable to play temporarily due to the nature of his/her disability or condition, the referee may, after consulting a medical classifier or doctor at the competition, allow a medical recovery time of the shortest practical duration, but in no circumstances more than 10 minutes.

In a doubles match, players **A** and **B** are in wheelchairs whilst player **X**, who is in a wheelchair, partners player Y, a standing para player who uses a walking stick for balance. During a rally, player **A**'s racket hand accidently touches the playing surface just before he hits the ball back over the net. The umpire should

a. call 'let' because **A** did not deliberately touch the playing surface with his racket hand
b. award a point to **X/Y** because **A**'s racket hand touched the playing surface before he hit the ball
c. take no action and allow the rally to continue
d. award a point to **X/Y** and warn **A** under PPS because he used his racket hand to support himself as he hit the ball

The correct answer is c.
2.10.1.14 if both players or pairs are in a wheelchair due to a physical disability and 2.10.1.14.2 his or her opponent touches the table with either hand before striking the ball.
Because all players are not in a wheelchair, 2.10.1.14.2 does not apply.
HMO Appendix F

In the following situations you have to say whether the umpire should award a point to A or A/B (A), award a point to X or X/Y (X), declare a let (L), or take no action (N).

During play, **X** trips over the moving cable of a mobile TV camera and misses the ball.

The correct answer is Let
2.9.2.4 because the conditions of play are disturbed in a way which could affect the outcome of the rally.

In a rally, while trying to return a shot/make a return, **X**'s run is blocked by a surround and she fails to make the return. **X** complains to the umpire saying that the playing area is too small.

*The correct answer is Point to **A***
The size of the playing area is not the umpire's responsibility, it is the same for both players and any complaints in this regard should have been to the referee before the match began.

During a rally, **A** strikes the ball and the ball touches the court of **X**, who attempts to return the ball but misses it. When **X** retrieves the ball, he notices it is broken and hands it to the umpire.

The correct answer is Point to A
FAQ 5.7 After the rally a player cannot claim that the ball was broken in the previous rally.

A serves and the ball bounces on his side of the table and touches the net, then **X** touches the playing surface with his free hand before the ball touches his court.

The correct answer is Point to A
2.10.1 Unless the rally is a let, a player shall score a point
2.10.1.11 if an opponent's free hand touches the playing surface

In doubles, as **A** serves, **B** stands in such a position that **X**, who is to receive, cannot see the ball until just before it is struck. **X** fails to make a good return.

The correct answer is Point to X/Y
2.6.4 From the start of service until it is struck, the ball shall be above the level of the playing surface and behind the server's end line, and it shall not be hidden from the receiver by the server or his or her doubles partner or by anything they wear or carry.

Player **A** strikes the ball which then bounces close to the net on his opponent's court and the ball bounces high. In an attempt to return the ball **X** stumbles and his racket falls on the table. He quickly restores his balance by leaning on the playing surface with the hand that just dropped the racket, grabs the racket and manages to return the ball.

The correct answer is Point to A
2.10.1.11 if an opponent's free hand touches the playing surface
2.5.6 The free hand is the hand not carrying the racket
In this case both hands of player X were free hands

In doubles, **A** receives but then realises that **B** should have received. To correct the error, he strikes the ball again when **X** returns it. **Y** misses **A**'s return.

The correct answer is Point to X/Y
2.10.1.12 if a doubles opponent strikes the ball out of the sequence established by the first server and first receiver

When **A** serves, the ball hits a finger of his racket hand, then his racket, and then bounces on his court, over the net and on to **X**'s court.

The correct answer is to take no action
2.10.1.7 if an opponent deliberately strikes the ball more than once in succession
The double hit was accidental, not deliberate

Player **A** projects the ball high in the air to serve but catches it in his free hand when he sees that it is falling so that he would have to strike it over the table.

The correct answer is Point to X
2.5.2 The ball is in play from the last moment at which it is stationary on the palm of the free hand before being intentionally projected in service until the rally is decided as a let or a point.
2.10.1.1 if an opponent fails to make a correct service

During a rally a ball struck by **X** hits the bracket clamping the net assembly to the table on **A**'s side of the table and falls onto the table. **A** fails to make a good return.

The correct answer is Point to X
2.2.1 The net assembly shall consist of the net, its suspension and the supporting posts, including the clamps attaching them to the table.
X made a correct return

X has the ball resting freely on the open palm of his stationary free hand. Then he decides that he would like to serve from another position. As he is changing his position, the ball falls to the floor.

The correct answer is to take no action
2.5.2 The ball is in play from the last moment at which it is stationary on the palm of the free hand before being intentionally projected in service until the rally is decided as a let or a point.
The ball is not yet in play so the rally hasn't started

Player **A**, when serving the ball in a singles match, mishits it. The ball hits the top edge of the end of the table on his side, rises in the air and then, without crossing the net, lands on the net clamp outside the table, and then bounces over the net and lands on **X**'s court. **X** was distracted by the service action and does not make a return.

The correct answer is Let
2.6.3 As the ball is falling the server shall strike it so that it touches first his or her court and then touches directly the receiver's court
2.9.1.1 if in service the ball touches the net assembly, provided the service is otherwise correct
Player A serves so the ball touches his court, then the net assembly, then touches X's court

A, a right-handed shake-hand player, in a desperate attempt to reach a ball on his left-hand side, changes his racket to his left hand, holding the racket by the blade and returns the ball by striking it with the racket handle.

The correct answer is to take no action
Players can change racket hand during the rally, and player A has struck the ball with a legal racket

During a doubles rally, **B** places her free hand on the table to regain her balance just as **A**, her partner, strikes the ball. The table was not moved, and **X** misses her return.

The correct answer is Point to X/Y
2.10.1.11 if an opponent's free hand touches the playing surface
Opponents are both A and B

A catches the ball with his free hand outside the sideline after the ball has travelled across the playing surface on his side without touching the table, but before the ball crosses his end line.

The correct answer is Point to A
2.10.1.4 if the ball passes over his or her court or beyond his or her end line without touching his or her court, after being struck by an opponent
The ball is out of play as soon as it passes over the court

X makes a good return and then stumbles and drops his racket. To steady himself, he rests the hand with which he had held the racket on the table, without moving it; **A**'s return misses the table.

The correct answer is Point to A
2.10.1.11 if an opponent's free hand touches the playing surface
2.5.6 The free hand is the hand not carrying the racket
In this case both hands of player X were free hands

A returns a drop shot, but as he does, he touches the playing surface with his racket hand without moving the table. **X** misses his next return.

The correct answer is Point to A
Touching the playing surface with the racket hand is allowed

In a doubles match, **A**, a standing athlete, serves to **X**, who is in a wheelchair because of a disability. The service, which is otherwise good, bounces in **X**'s right half court and then goes off the side of the table. **X** makes no attempt to return the ball.

The correct answer is Point to A/B
2.9.1 The rally shall be a let
2.9.1.5 if the receiver is in wheelchair owing to a physical disability and in service the ball, provided that the service is otherwise correct,
2.9.1.5.3 in singles leaves the receiver's court after touching it by either of its sidelines.
Since this is a doubles match, in service the ball is allowed to go over the sideline, so A has made a good service and X has not made a return

In a singles match **X**, a standing athlete, serves to **A**, who is in a wheelchair because of a disability. The serve, which is otherwise good, bounces in **A**'s right half court and then goes off the side of the table. **A** returns the ball and **X** misses the subsequent return.

The correct answer is Let
2.9.1 The rally shall be a let
2.9.1.5 if the receiver is in wheelchair owing to a physical disability and in service the ball, provided that the service is otherwise correct,
2.9.1.5.3 in singles leaves the receiver's court after touching it by either of its sidelines.
The rally is decided as a Let as soon as the ball crosses the sideline regardless of what the receiver does afterwards

In doubles, **A** serves but **X** catches the ball saying that it bounced on the wrong half-court, although the umpire is sure that it did not.

The correct answer is Point to A
3.3.2.3 The umpire shall be responsible for:
3.3.2.3.6 deciding each rally as a point or a let
It is up to the umpire to decide, not the player

The umpire is sure that the ball returned by **A** missed the table, but **A** insists that it hit the top edge of the end of the playing surface and **X** refuses to comment.

The correct answer is Point to X
3.3.2.3 The umpire shall be responsible for:
3.3.2.3.6 deciding each rally as a point or a let
It is up to the umpire to decide, not the player

In a match between player **A** (attacker) vs player **X** (defender), player **X** is far behind the table returning the ball. **A** plays a drop ball and **X** runs to the table, touches it with his body, moving the surface just a little but did not move the table from its position. **X** makes a good return that **A** fails to reach.

The correct answer is Point to X
HMO 12.1.2
….The rule regarding moving the playing surface is more than 50 years old and comes from a time where we had no rollaway tables; nowadays tables have hinges and a light push or even stamping on the floor can move the playing surface. Because of this, most umpires do not apply the rule strictly and it would be impossible to play wheelchair table tennis if "moving the playing surface" was enforced. Only lifting, permanent shifting, displacement, or intentional shaking the tabletop should result in the awarding of a point.

In a wheelchair doubles match **A** serves to **X**; the service has so much backspin that it touches **X**'s right half court and returns in the direction of the net. **X** is unable to reach the ball to make a return.

The correct answer is Let
2.9.1 The rally shall be a let
2.9.1.5 if the receiver is in wheelchair owing to a physical disability and in service the ball, provided that the service is otherwise correct,
2.9.1.5.1 after touching the receiver's court returns in the direction of the net
The rally is decided as a Let as soon as the ball returns in the direction of the net

Just as player **X**, a Class 2 wheelchair player, is about to return a wide angled shot, one wheel falls off his chair and he fails to make a good return.

The correct answer is Point to A
Player X has not made a good return and losing a wheel is unfortunate but not a valid reason for not making a return

In a wheelchair singles match, player **A** stretches forward and makes a strong smash which player **X** is unable to return. It was observed that the rear part of one of **A**'s thighs was not in contact with his seat as he struck the ball.

The correct answer is Point to A
2.10.1.14 if both players or pairs are in a wheelchair due to a physical disability and
2.10.1.14.1 his or her opponent does not maintain a minimum contact with the seat or cushion(s), with the back of the thigh, when the ball is struck;
HMO Appendix F/HMO 12.1.6
A player who is in a wheelchair due to a physical disability and who does not maintain a contact with the seat or cushion with the rear side of at least one of the thighs just before striking the ball is considered to be gaining an unfair advantage and the opponent is awarded a point.
Since one of A's thighs was in contact with his seat it was a good return

In a doubles match, **A** and **X** are standing athletes, whilst their partners, **B** and **Y**, are in wheelchairs. During a rally, as **B** makes a return, **A**'s foot crosses over the imaginary extension of the centre line of the table.

The correct answer is Point to X/Y
2.10.1 Unless the rally is a let, a player shall score a point
2.10.1.15 if, where an opposing doubles pair includes at least one player in a wheelchair, any part of the wheelchair or a foot of a standing player crosses an imaginary extension of the centre line of the table
Each player must stay on their own side of the centre line or it is a point to their opponent

In a doubles match, two wheelchair players, **A** and **B** are playing against a standing player **X** and wheelchair player **Y**. During a rally, player **X** returns the ball twice in succession.

The correct answer is to take no action
2.8.3 In doubles, when at least one player of a pair is in a wheelchair due to a physical disability, the server shall first make a service, the receiver shall then make a return but thereafter either player of the disabled pair may make returns.
Either player may make returns

In a wheelchair singles match between **A** and **X**, **A**'s racket hand touches his side of the table just before he makes a good return.

The correct answer is Point to X
2.10.1.14 if both players or pairs are in a wheelchair due to a physical disability and 2.10.1.14.2 his or her opponent touches the table with either hand before striking the ball
In wheelchair matches players are not allowed to touch the table with either hand before striking the ball

Standing Para player **A** uses a walking stick to maintain his balance while playing. In a singles match against **X**, as **A** makes a good return during a rally the walking stick slips on the floor causing **A** to fall onto the floor. **X** makes a good return.

The correct answer is to take no action
The ball is still in play and there is nothing in the question to indicate that A has not subsequently returned the ball

In a wheelchair singles match, **A** uses the free hand to push onto the wheelchair to get additional leverage and support to return a high ball.

The correct answer is to take no action
The ball is still in play and there is nothing in the question to indicate that A has raised her thighs from the chair

Our best wishes to all of you

ITTF Umpires and Referee Committee

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